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Beginner-Friendly Product Validation Toolkit (2026)

So you have a product idea that looks promising. But you are worried about putting your money into stock, only to find out nobody wants to buy it. Good thinking. The biggest mistake...



7 pages · PDF

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11 Ready to Test Your Product Idea?

So you have a product idea that looks promising. But you are worried about putting your money into stock, only to find out nobody wants to buy it. Good thinking. The biggest mistake new sellers make is skipping this check and hoping for the best.

This guide shows you how to test your product idea before you spend serious money. We have also listed free tools that make the testing simple, even from your phone.

01 What Product Validation Means

Product validation simply means checking that people will really pay for your product before you buy plenty of it.

Most product ideas sound better in your head than they do in the real market. Testing first saves you from costly mistakes. Instead of buying 500 pieces of something nobody wants from Balogun or Alaba, you will know within 48 to 72 hours if your idea has a real chance.

It does not matter if you make your products yourself (shea butter, adire, small chops) or buy from suppliers. Studying the market and listening to customers is what separates a profitable idea from an expensive lesson.

It also builds confidence. Nothing beats knowing people want what you are selling before you launch.

02 What Makes a Product Worth Selling

Every product worth selling has these three things:

1. Real demand from real people (not just your friends being nice to you)
2. A good profit after all your costs, including delivery
3. Not too many sellers, or a clear reason to buy from you instead

Quick test: If you cannot find at least 10 people willing to pay within one week, rethink the product.

03 Free Product Validation Tools You Can Use Today

- **Google Trends:** Set the country to Nigeria and see if people are searching for your product, and in which states.
- **Jumia and Jiji:** See what is already selling, how it is priced and what buyers say in reviews.
- **Instagram and TikTok search:** Type your product name and see how many sellers and how much engagement (likes, comments, “how much?”) it gets.

- **Facebook Groups and WhatsApp groups:** Find the groups where your customers already gather.
- **Nairaland:** Read what problems people complain about in the business, fashion and family sections.

Start with Google Trends and Jumia for the quickest answers.

04 The 72-Hour Product Validation Process

You do not need months of research. Here is how to test any product idea in three days:

Day 1: Research. Spend 2 to 3 hours searching for your product on Jumia, Jiji, Instagram and Google. Read the reviews and comments, especially the middle ones where people share honest good and bad points. Check if similar products exist and write down their prices.

Day 2: Audience test. Post in 3 to 5 Facebook groups, WhatsApp groups or your WhatsApp Status where your customers spend time. Do not spam. Ask a real question like "Does anyone struggle with [problem your product solves]?" Count the replies and screenshot the comments that show interest.

Day 3: Collect interest. Make a simple order form with Google Forms, or a simple product page on your own store. Share it with the people who showed interest. If 20 or more people give you their WhatsApp number or say "I'll buy this," you have proof of demand. If a few even send a deposit by bank transfer, even better.

05 Signs Your Product Idea Is Solid

Look for these signals while you research and talk to customers:

- People ask "how much?" or "where can I buy it?" before you mention selling
- Several strangers offer to pay upfront or send a deposit
- Similar products on Jumia or Instagram have plenty of recent reviews and comments
- Search interest on Google Trends stays steady over 12 months
- You can explain the benefit in one sentence

The more of these signals you see, the better the chance that customers will accept your product.

06 Red Flags That Mean Keep Searching

Not every idea is worth chasing. Walk away if you notice:

- Only friends and family show interest
- You need more than 30 seconds to explain what it does
- Nobody else is selling it at all (this often means there is no demand)
- Your profit is less than 30% of the selling price after all costs, including delivery and payment fees
- It only sells 2 to 3 months of the year (for example, only in Detty December or back-to-school in September), unless you plan for that

Remember: having no idea is better than chasing a bad one that eats your money, time and energy.

07 Pricing Validation Method

Testing your price matters as much as testing the product.

Try this simple approach:

Ask 20 people to choose between three prices: low, middle and high. For example, ₦8,500, ₦12,000 and ₦15,500 for a ready-to-wear ankara set. If most choose the lowest price, people may not see enough value in the product. If most choose the highest, you can charge more.

The sweet spot is when about 6 or 7 out of 10 people choose your middle price.

08 Talking to Real Potential Customers

The best test comes from real conversations.

Reach out to 10 people who fit your customer type, by WhatsApp chat, voice note or face to face. Ask:

- “What is your biggest frustration with [problem area]?”
- “How are you solving it now?”
- “Would you pay ₦[amount] to fix this problem?”

Listen more than you talk. The exact words customers use will tell you how to advertise your product later.

09 Free Product Validation Toolkit

Tool	What It Does	Plan
Google Trends	Shows search interest in Nigeria	Free
Jumia / Jiji	Shows prices and reviews of similar products	Free
Google Forms	Collects orders, interest and survey answers	Free
WhatsApp Business	Polls on Status, chats and broadcast lists to test interest	Free
Canva	Makes simple flyers and product mock-ups to share	Free

10 Moving from Validation to Launch

Once your idea has passed the test, take these next steps:

- Buy a small test batch first (10 to 25 pieces at most). You can also dropship from verified Nigerian suppliers on Shopinbos, so you do not need to hold stock at all.
- Take simple product photos with your phone, near a window in daylight.
- Write your product description using the words customers used in your chats.
- Launch on one or two channels first (for example, Instagram plus your own store) and gather real feedback.

Do not aim for perfect. Aim to learn what works with real customers.

11 Ready to Test Your Product Idea?

Pick one method from this toolkit, promise yourself to finish it within 72 hours, and find out if your idea deserves your money.

Your profitable business starts with testing your ideas today, not guessing tomorrow. Test small, learn fast and launch smart.

When you are ready to sell, Shopinbos helps you find products from verified Nigerian suppliers, get an online store built by Rex, and take payments and arrange deliveries in one place. It is free to start. Visit shopinbos.com and turn your tested idea into real sales.

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